Sivenesi Subramoney

Postdoctoral Fellow in Psychology
Virginia Commonwealth University, Richmond, VA 23284, USA
subramoneys@vcu.edu sivenesi.github.io | *Updated:* 02 Nov 2026

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Socioemotional development
Emotion and interpersonal processes

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Virginia Commonwealth University (VCU), USA July 2025 - Present
Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Psychology
Mentors: Fantasy T. Lozada & Chelsea D. Williams

EDUCATION

University of California, Merced, USA 2019 - 2025
Ph.D. in Psychological Sciences, Developmental Psychology
With Certificate in Quantitative Methods
Dissertation Committee: Eric A. Walle (chair), Alexandra Main, Rose Scott, & Dalia Magaña

University of Cape Town, South Africa 2016
M.A. in Neuropsychology (with distinction)
Advisors: Kevin Thomas and Melike Fourie (co-advisor)

University of Cape Town, South Africa 2012
B. Soc Sci Honors in Psychology (First class pass)
Advisors: Kevin Thomas and Melike Fourie (co-advisor)

University of Cape Town, South Africa 2011
B. Soc Sci in Psychology and isiXhosa (with distinction in isiXhosa and degree with distinction)

PUBLICATIONS

Lozada, F. T., Bryant, S. C., **Subramoney, S**., & Brown, K. (in press). Emotion regulation and expression in minoritized communities: A triple quandary framework for cultural and contextual understanding. In V. LoBue, K., Pérez-Edgar, & K.A., Buss, (Eds.), *Handbook of Emotional Development: Advances in Theory, Research, and Practice*. Springer Nature.

Bacchas, R., Williams, C. D., Atkin, A. L., Christophe, N. K., West, T., Sobolewski, C. M., **Subramoney, S**., Olivares, D., Green, M., & Bravo, D. Y. (in press). The impacts of Multiracial socialization and school racial composition on Multiracial pride among Biracial adolescents. Identity: An International Journal of Theory and Research. doi.org/10.1080/15283488.2026.2703644

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., & Camras, L. A. (in press). Emotional development in different cultural contexts. In M. Yik (Ed.), Handbook of Emotion and Culture. Oxford University Press.

Walle, E. A., Özden, Z.B., **Subramoney, S.**, & Ganesh Kumar, M. (in press). Emotional signals: Communicators of relational significance. In S. P. Johnson (Ed.), *Handbook of Perceptual Development*. Oxford University Press.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E.A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2025). Emotion brokering in Latinxs: Associations with depressive symptoms and acculturative stress. *Emotion*, 25(6), 1536-1549. doi.org/10.1037/emo0001506

Subramoney, S., Walle, E.A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2025). Cultural brokering in immigrant families. *Child Development Perspectives*, 19(3), 165- 171. doi.org/10.1111/cdep.12539

Subramoney, S., Walle, E.A., Main, A., & Magaña, D.(2025). Navigating intercultural misunderstandings: An examination of emotion brokering. *Cultural Diversity and Ethnic Minority Psychology*, 31(3), 429–441. doi.org/10.1037/cdp0000652

Meiring, L., **Subramoney, S.**, Thomas, K. G., Decety, J., & Fourie, M. M. (2014). Empathy and helping: Effects of racial group membership and cognitive load. *South African Journal of Psychology*, 44(4), 426-438. doi.org/10.1177/0081246314530280

Publications authored as researcher at the University of Cape Town

These publications are related to my prior role as a researcher on the neuroimaging component of the Drakenstein Child Health Study

Ghasoub, M., Scholten, C., Geeraert, B., Long, X., Joshi, S., Wedderburn, C. J., Roos, A., **Subramoney, S.**, Hoffman, N., Narr, K., Woods, R., Zar, H. J., Stein, D. J., Donald, K., & Lebel, C. (2025). The effects of prenatal alcohol exposure on structural brain connectivity and early language skills in a South African birth cohort. *Neurobiology of Language*, 6, Article nol_a_00161. doi.org/10.1162/nol_a_00161

Ringshaw, J. E., Hendrikse, C. J., Wedderburn, C. J., Bradford, L. E., Williams, S. R., Nyakonda, C. N., **Subramoney, S.**, Lake, M. T., Burd, T., Hoffman, N., Roos, A., Narr, K. L., Joshi, S. H., Williams, S. C. R., Zar, H. J., Stein, D. J., & Donald, K. A. (2025). Persistent impact of antenatal maternal anaemia on child brain structure at 6–7 years of age: A South African child health study. *BMC Medicine*, 23(1), 94. doi.org/10.1016/j.nicl.2024.103572

Scholten, C., Ghasoub, M., Geeraert, B., Joshi, S., Wedderburn, C. J., Roos, A., **Subramoney, S.**, Hoffman, N., Narr, K., Woods, R., Zar, H. J., Stein, D. J., Donald, K., & Lebel, C. (2024). Prenatal tobacco and alcohol exposure, white matter microstructure, and early language skills in toddlers from a South African birth cohort. *Frontiers in Integrative Neuroscience*, 18, 1438888. doi.org/10.3389/fnint.2024.1438888

Wedderburn, C. J., Yeung, S., Groenewold, N. A., Rehman, A. M., **Subramoney, S.**, Fouche, J.-P., Joshi, S. H., Narr, K. L., Hoffman, N., Roos, A., Gibb, D. M., Zar, H. J., Stein, D. J., & Donald, K. A (2024). Subcortical brain volumes and neurocognitive function in children with perinatal HIV exposure: A population-based cohort study in South Africa. *Open Forum Infectious Diseases*, 11(7), ofae317. doi.org/10.1093/ofid/ofae317

Wedderburn, C. J., Yeung, S., **Subramoney, S.**, Fouche, J. P., Joshi, S. H., Narr, K. L., et al. (2024). Association of in utero HIV exposure with child brain structure and language development: A South African birth cohort study. *BMC Medicine*, 22(1), 129. doi.org/10.1162/nol_a_00161

Donald, K. A., Hendrikse, C. J., Roos, A., Wedderburn, C. J., **Subramoney, S**., et al. (2024). Prenatal alcohol exposure and white matter microstructural changes across the first 6–7 years of life: A longitudinal diffusion tensor imaging study of a South African birth cohort. *NeuroImage: Clinical*, 41, 103572. doi.org/10.1016/j.nicl.2024.103572

Pellowski, J. A., Wedderburn, C. J., Groenewold, N. A., Roos, A., **Subramoney, S**., et al. (2023). Maternal perinatal depression and child brain structure at 2–3 years in a South African birth cohort study. *Translational Psychiatry*, 13(1), 96. doi/10.1038/s41398-023-02395-5

Wedderburn, C. J., Ringshaw, J. E., Donald, K. A., Joshi, S. H., **Subramoney, S**., et al. (2022). Association of maternal and child anemia with brain structure in early life in South Africa. *JAMA Network Open*, 5(12), e2244772. doi/10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2022.44772

Subramoney, S., Joshi, S. H., Wedderburn, C. J., Lee, D., Roos, A., Woods, R. P., et al. (2022). The impact of prenatal alcohol exposure on gray matter volume and cortical surface area of 2- to 3-year-old children in a South African birth cohort. *Alcoholism: Clinical and Experimental Research*, 46(7), 1233–1247. doi.org/10.1111/acer.14873

Bertran-Cobo, C., Wedderburn, C. J., Robertson, F. C., **Subramoney, S**., Narr, K. L., et al. (2022). A neurometabolic pattern of elevated myo-inositol in children who are HIV-exposed and uninfected: A South African birth cohort study. *Frontiers in Immunology*, 13, 800273. doi.org/10.3389/fimmu.2022.800273

Roos, A., Wedderburn, C. J., Fouche, J. P., **Subramoney, S**., Joshi, S. H., et al. (2021). Central white matter integrity alterations in 2–3-year-old children following prenatal alcohol exposure. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence*, 225, 108826. doi.org/10.1016/j.drugalcdep.2021.108826

Wedderburn, C. J.,**Subramoney, S**., Yeung, S., Fouche, J. P., Joshi, S. H., Narr, K. L., et al. (2020). Neuroimaging young children and associations with neurocognitive development in a South African birth cohort study. *NeuroImage*, 219, 116846. doi.org/10.1016/j.neuroimage.2020.116846

Subramoney, S., Eastman, E., Adnams, C., Stein, D. J., & Donald, K. A. (2018). The early developmental outcomes of prenatal alcohol exposure: A review. *Frontiers in Neurology*, 9, 1108. doi.org/10.3389/fneur.2018.01108

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW/REVISION

+Undergraduate author

Subramoney, S., +Cardoza Cortez, M.A., Main, A., Magaña, D. & Walle, E.A. (under review). The effects of emotion brokering frequency and gender on maternal relationship quality.

Subramoney S., Gómez Giuliani N., Tirado C., Williams C.D., Lozada, F.T., Sullivan T., The Spit for Science Working Group, & Dick D.M., (under review). Associations between ethnic-racial identity components and emotion functioning.

Subramoney, S., & Walle, E.A. (under review). Children's teaching of novel emotion norms.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Subramoney, S.., Williams, C. D., Lozada, F.T., Gomes, M., Bryant, S., West, T., Pham, A., Tirado, C., Morales, L., The Spit for Science Working Group, & Dick, M. (in prep). The associations

between emotion socialization, emotion regulation, and depressive symptoms among racially diverse emerging adults.

Subramoney, S., & Walle, E.A. (in prep). Emotion brokering among South African young adults.

Lozada, F.T. & **Subramoney, S**. (in prep). Families' navigation of multiple contexts in their daily lives. In E. Hernandez Acton & J.C. Dunsmore., *A research agenda for emotion socialization.* Edward Elgar Publishing.

Subramoney, S., Lozada, F.T. & Williams, C.D. (in prep). Interpersonal emotion regulation and emotional well-being among ethnically minoritized college students.

Subramoney, S., Lozada, F.T. & Williams, C.D. (in prep). Emotion flexibility behaviors among minoritized youth.

Özden, Z.B. & **Subramoney, S.** (in prep). Social evaluation of emotion norm violations in middle childhood: The role of cultural values.

GRANTS

A Daily Diary Investigation of Interpersonal Emotion Regulation and Emotional Well-Being Among Ethnically Minoritized College Students. (PI's **Subramoney, S.,** Lozada, F.T., & Williams, C.D.). Institute for Research on Behavior and Emotional Health pilot funding program (USD 12, 500).

HONORS AND AWARDS

University of California, Merced

Graduate Dean's Dissertation Fellowship, USD 27,214	Spring 2025
"*You made a difference*." Recognition of impact on undergraduate students	2024
Distinguished Graduate Speaker in Psychological Sciences	2024
Outstanding Graduate Student in Developmental Psychology	2023- 2024
Graduate Student Travel Grant, USD 350	2023
Psychological Sciences Graduate Student Research Award, USD 4,150	2020- 2023
Oppenheimer Memorial Trust (OMT) Award for Graduate Study, USD 27,900	2020 - 2023

University of Cape Town, South Africa

National Research Foundation Innovation Masters Scholarship, ZAR 70 000/year	2013 - 2015
National Research Foundation Freestanding Scholarship, ZAR 20 000	2012
Humanities Faculty Scholarship, ZAR 20 000/year	2010- 2011
Class medal- achieved first position in class (Xhosa Communications)	2010
Deans Merit List	2009- 2011

PRESENTATIONS

Chaired Conference Symposia

Subramoney, S., (2026, March). Emotion expressions and the norms that govern them. Society for Affective Science 2026 Annual Conference. Pittsburgh, USA.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2023, July). Understanding and navigating cultural differences in emotional communication. International Association for Cross-Cultural Psychology. Limerick, Ireland.

Institutional Talks

Subramoney, S. (2025, Aug). Emotion Brokering: Helping others navigate intercultural emotion-based misunderstandings. A talk presented at the Developmental Psychology Seminar, Virginia Commonwealth University, Richmond, USA.

Subramoney, S. (2024, Nov). Emotion Brokering: Helping others navigate intercultural emotion-based misunderstandings. Distinguished Graduate Student in Psychological Sciences Speaker Series, Merced, USA.

Conference Talks

Subramoney, S & Lozada, F.T. (2025, September). Emotion flexibility behavior development among minoritized youth. A flash talk presented at the Mid-Atlantic Society of Affective Science, Winston-Salem, USA.

Subramoney, S & Walle, E.A. (2024, July). The relationship between bicultural identity and the emotion brokering experience among U.S. Latinxs. Paper presented at the International Congress for the International Association for Cross-Cultural Psychology, Bali, Indonesia.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2024, May). Emotion brokering: Helping others navigate intercultural emotion-based misunderstandings. Bay Area Developmental Symposium, Palo Alto, USA.

+Cardoza Cortez, M.A., **Subramoney, S**., & Walle, E.A. (2024, April). The effects of emotion brokering frequency and gender on maternal relationship quality. Talk presented at the National Conference on Undergraduate Research, Long Beach, USA.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2023, July). Emotion Brokering: Helping others navigate intercultural emotion-based misunderstandings. International Association for Cross-Cultural Psychology. Limerick, Ireland.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2023, June). Emotion Brokering and mental health: The role of family support values. Paper presented at the Broader Bay Area Affective Science Society Meeting, Davis, USA.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2022, July). The effects of emotion brokering on mental health: It depends on how you feel about it. Paper presented at the International Society for Research on Emotion Development Preconference, Los Angeles, USA.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2022, July). Emotion brokering in U.S. Latinxs: Associations with mental health and stress. Paper presented at the International Congress of Cross-Cultural Psychology, Virtual.

Subramoney, S., & Walle, E. A. (2021, April). The effects of gender and heritage cultural identity on emotion brokering outcomes. Paper presented at the Society for Affective Science Meeting, Virtual.

Conference Posters

+Undergraduate author

Subramoney, S., Williams, C. D., Lozada, F.T., Gomes, M., Bryant, S., West, T., Pham, A., Tirado, C., Morales, L., The Spit for Science Working Group1, & Dick, M. (Submitted). The associations between emotion socialization, emotion regulation, and depressive symptoms among racially diverse emerging adults. Poster to be presented at the Society for Research on Child Development, Atlanta, USA.

McGill-Veloso, N., Kerr, N., **Subramoney, S**., & Lozada, F. (2026, April). Examining factors that influence African American parents' racial emotion socialization strategies. Poster presented at the Society for Research on Adolescence, Toronto, Canada.

Subramoney, S., +Cardoza Cortez, M.A., & Walle, E.A. (2024, July). The effects of emotion brokering frequency and gender on maternal relationship quality. Poster presented at the International Society for Research on Emotion, Belfast, Northern Ireland.

Subramoney, S. & Walle, E.A. (2024, June). The relationship between bicultural identity and the emotion brokering experience among U.S. Latinxs. Poster presented at the Broader Bay Area Affective Science Society Meeting, Berkeley, USA.

Subramoney, S., Özden, Z.B., Ocampo, D., Lopez, L.D., & Walle, E. A. (2023, April). Extrinsic emotion regulation in infancy and early childhood. *Affective Science*, 5, 24. [High ranking abstract: Poster presented at the Society for Affective Science, Long Beach, USA.]

Özden, Z.B., Ocampo, D.B., **Subramoney, S.**, Lopez, L.D., & Walle E.A. (2023, March). Extrinsic emotion regulation in infancy and early childhood. Poster presented at Society for Research on Child Development, Salt Lake City, USA.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2022, July). The effects of emotion brokering on mental health: It depends on how you feel about it. Poster presented at the International Society for Research on Emotion, Los Angeles, USA.

Subramoney, S., Walle, E. A., Main, A., & Magaña, D. (2022, February). The effects of emotion brokering on mental health: It depends on how you feel about it. Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Conference and virtual Emotion Pre-Conference, San Francisco, USA.

Subramoney, S., & Walle, E. A. (2021, February). Emotion brokering: Navigating cross-cultural differences in emotion norms. Poster presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Emotion Pre- Conference, Virtual. [Best poster award winner]

Subramoney, S., Wedderburn, C. J., Roos, A., Ipser, J. C., Zar, H. J., Woods, R. P., et al. (2020). Altered subcortical grey matter volume in 2–3-year-old children with prenatal alcohol exposure in a South African birth cohort. *Alcoholism: Clinical and Experimental Research*, 44, 70-70. [Meeting cancelled]

Wedderburn, C. J., Yeung, S., **Subramoney, S**., Fouche, J.P., Joshi, S.H., Narr, K.L., Rehman, A.M., Roos, A., Gibb, G.M., Zar, H.J., Stein, D.J., Donald, K.A. (2020, July). Mapping cortical structure and neurocognitive development of HIV-exposed uninfected children in South Africa: Neuroimaging outcomes from a South African birth cohort. International AIDS Conference, virtual.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Virginia Commonwealth University

Instructor of Record (20-30 student classes)

Social Psychology of Emotions	Fall 2026
Social Psychology of Emotions (rating: 4.9 out of 5)	Spring 2026

University of California, Merced

Guest Lectures (60-80 student classes)

Neurodevelopmental Disorders, Psychopathology	April 2024
Childhood Sexual Development, Human Sexuality	March 2023

Teaching Assistantship Discussion/Seminar Leader (30 student classes)

Analysis of Psychological Data with *Ana Simeos* (rating: 6.1 out of 7)	Fall 2023
Analysis of Psychological Data with *Ren Lui* (rating: 6.4 out of 7)	Fall 2021

Teaching Assistantships (60-80 student classes)

Social Cognition with *Jason Emory* (rating: 6.5 out of 7)	Fall 2024
Psychopathology with *Robert Yancey* (rating: 6.1 out of 7)	Spring 2024
Human Sexuality with *Ross Avilla* (rating: 6.1 out of 7)	Spring 2023
Research Methods with *Jason Emory* (rating: 6.1 out of 7)	Fall 2022
Culture/Racial/Ethnic Diversity with *Daniel Mello* (rating: 6.7 out of 7)	Spring 2022
Developmental Psychology with *Jason Isbell* (rating: 6.4 out of 7)	Spring 2021
Clinical Neuropsychology with *Alexander Khislavsky* (rating: 6.1 out of 7)	Fall 2020
Abnormal Child Psychology with *Paul Carroll* (rating: 6.4 out of 7)	Spring 2020
Stereotype and Prejudice with *Paul Carroll* (rating: 6.4 out of 7)	Fall 2019

University of Cape Town

Tutor for Research Methodology (I and II) and Statistics with *Muya Koloko*	2013-2017

MENTORSHIP

Virginia Commonwealth University

Co-advised undergraduate research projects/theses

Daniela Djeukeng (currently in postbaccalaureate research program)	2025- Present

Students mentored in research lab

Skylar Reid	2025- Present
Sumaiya Tabassum	2025

University of California, Merced

Co-advised undergraduate research projects/theses

Marcela Cardoza Cortez	2024
Bailey Weikel-Feekes	2021

Students mentored in research lab

Alexandra Espinoza, Emily Rodriguez, Camila Valenzuela	2024-2025
Jessica De Haro, Gagandeep Kaur	2023- 2024
Leslie Simental, Elisa Sosa	2022-2023
Maria Perez	2021-2023
Jazmin Sandoval	2020- 2021

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Ad hoc Journal Reviews

Child Psychiatry & Human Development
Review of Education Health Psychology and Behavioral Medicine
International Journal of Intercultural Relations
Social Psychology of Education (Co-reviewed) Wellcome Open Research

Service to university and academy

VCU Graduate research symposium judge	April, 2026
VCU Graduate student recruitment	Jan, 2026
Reviewer, National Conference for Undergraduate Research	Dec, 2025
UC Merced PsyChi panel on graduate school April, 2025 UC Merced graduate student panel for prospective students	2021-2024

MEDIA COVERAGE AND OTHER ARTICLES

Cultural brokering research featured on UC Merced News	Jan, 2025
Research on emotion brokering featured on ABC 30 Action News	June, 2024
Article on emotion brokering featured on UC Merced News	April, 2024
Opinion Article in The Student Notebook, Association for Psychological Science (APS) Co-authored with Enzo Cáceres Quezada (University of Amsterdam) and Kunalan Manokara (Duke University)	2023

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Research Assistant (PI Kirsty Donald), University of Cape Town	2017-2019
Training Facilitator of the Early Learning Outcomes Measure	2016-2018
Research Assistant at Child Development Research Lab, University of Cape Town	2013-2017

MEMBERSHIPS AND AFFILIATIONS

International Society for Research on Emotion, student member 2022- Present
International Congress for Research on Cross-Cultural Psychology, student member 2022- Present
Society for Affective Science, student member 2021- Present
South African Neuropsychology Association 2018- 2019
American Psychological Association (APA), International Affiliate 2017-2019

PEDAGOGICAL TRAINING COURSES, AND CERTIFICATES

Principles of Pedagogy, research-based teaching series, UC Merced 2023
Teaching series designed to prepare future instructors for their careers in teaching, covering lesson design, student-centered syllabi, and teaching technologies
Preparing to Teach in the Online Environment, UC Merced 2020
Training to deliver high-quality and effective teaching online via Zoom/conferencing software
Accredited Early Learning Outcomes Measure Assessor 2016